

One square. Six letters.

Before reading an opinion, find out what is actually planned.

Editor's verified facts

Seabreeze Council wants to test a **six-Friday trial** in Seabreeze Square. Up to **eight food trucks** could sell food from **5:00 pm to 8:00 pm**. The plan includes **rubbish bins**, an **easy walking path** and a **check-up after the trial**.

This report does not prove if there will be loud noise, lost parking, extra rubbish, or if everyone will enjoy it.

Five clues of biased writing

1. **Strong feeling words** make things sound very good, bad or scary.
2. **Sweeping statements** claim that everybody agrees.
3. **Guessing reasons** pretends to know why people act.
4. **Leaving things out** hides facts that do not fit.
5. **Acting too sure** treats a guess about the future like a fact.

Stop the Friday Food-Truck Mess

A

MARINA VALE, SQUARE RESIDENT

Seabreeze Square is about to turn into a noisy food-truck mess. Careless town leaders seem to care more about taking colourful photos than about the people who live here. Everyone who lives here knows that eight loud trucks, long lines and music will ruin our quiet Friday nights.

The council calls this a six-week test, but we all know what happens: once the trucks arrive, they will never leave! Finding a car park will be impossible, rubbish will blow down the street and local cafes will lose all their customers. Nobody asked us if we wanted our quiet square turned into a food court.

The council must stop this silly plan right now. Leaders must protect our square or admit that visitors matter more than local families.

SIMPLIFIED CLASSROOM TEXT | PAGE 2

The loud pull

Different opinions can use the same unfair tricks.

Let the Town Wake Up

THEO GRANT, HOSPITALITY STUDENT

At last, someone is helping our quiet town centre! Food trucks will fill Seabreeze Square with colour, yummy food and laughter. Only a few grumpy people could complain about such a great idea.

Everyone knows the square is totally empty on Friday nights. The trial will bring families together, help struggling shops and give young people a fun place to go. People only complain about parking because they fear any new idea.

There are only two choices: welcome the trucks or let our town stay boring. The council should ignore the complainers and start the food trucks right away!

B

Parking First, Please

RAVI SINGH, NEARBY RESIDENT

The food-truck test should not start in Seabreeze Square until the council fixes the parking problem. On trial nights, twelve car parks beside the square will be closed to regular cars. Local residents and shop customers need those spaces.

Closing them will push cars into nearby streets and make parking hard. This will annoy local residents and keep shoppers away from nearby stores. The council should choose a different spot before approving the trial.

Fun Friday night events might be nice, but parking must come first.

C

SIMPLIFIED CLASSROOM TEXT | PAGE 3

The quiet pull

Calm words can still leave out facts or guess too much.

A Chance for Young People D

LENA CHO, YOUTH COMMITTEE MEMBER

Seabreeze needs more places where young people and families can spend time together. A Friday food-truck trial would give the square a friendly purpose after the shops close. At our youth committee meeting, several students said they would love to go with friends and family.

The plan brings different foods to try and a reason to meet outside. Events like this bring people together, support food sellers and make young people feel welcome. Many families will enjoy a fun, affordable night out close to home.

The council should approve the trial and show that young people's ideas matter.

Trial It, Measure It, Adjust It E

MARA ELLIS, COMMUNITY VOLUNTEER

The food-truck plan could bring new life to Seabreeze Square, but neighbours have good reasons to ask about noise, parking and rubbish. The plan is only a test for six Fridays from 5:00 pm to 8:00 pm, with only eight food trucks.

The council should only go ahead if there are clear walking paths and plenty of bins. During the trial, workers should count visitors, check for litter and listen to local shop owners. Checking these things will give us real facts instead of wild guesses from both sides.

I support the trial because we can test it and check the results. If big problems happen, the council can change the hours, reduce the number of trucks or move to another spot.

Balanced and still persuasive

A fair writer can see both sides and suggest a sensible plan.

Protect the Square While Testing the Idea

OWEN PARK, ACCESS ADVOCATE

F

Supporters are right that a community evening helps people gather, but neighbours are also right that the square must stay safe and easy to walk through. The current plan includes a clear path for prams and wheelchairs, but it does not yet show how people will pass if long lines form.

The council should start with four trucks on the first two Fridays, mark the walking paths clearly and have a helper guide people safely. Then they can share what they saw before adding more trucks. Starting small is a safe way to test the idea while listening to both sides.

A careful test can bring fun new events while protecting our everyday square.

Balanced-language field guide

Name the source: The writer explains...

Agree with a point: Neighbours have a good reason to...

Use careful words: might, could, perhaps...

Spot missing facts: The plan does not show yet...

Suggest an action: The council should test, check and review...

Writer's challenge: Share your real opinion clearly without using mean, exaggerated or guessing words.